SPECIAL COMPETITIVE STUDIES PROJECT

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President and CEO
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Submitted via Email to: [redacted]

Attn: Faisal D'Souza
NCO 2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314, USA

Date: 14 March 2025

Re: Input from the Special Competitive Studies Project on the Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan (FR Doc. 2025-02305)

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

On behalf of the Special Competitive Studies Project (SCSP), I am pleased to provide this comprehensive input[1] for the development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan. SCSP carries forward the vital mission of the National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence (NSCAI), which was established in 2018 and had briefed President Trump in 2019 on its initial work. We have been deeply engaged in formulating recommendations to bolster America's long-term competitiveness in the face of rapidly evolving technological landscapes, particularly concerning the rise of artificial intelligence. We recognize that this is not merely a technological challenge, but a geopolitical imperative, with profound implications for our national security, economic prosperity, and societal

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well-being. The People's Republic of China (PRC), in particular, presents a strategic challenge, and our AI strategy must be crafted with this competition in mind.

This response builds upon the foundational 2019 Executive Order (EO), 13895, "Maintaining American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence," and is further informed by the January 2025 Executive Order, 14179, "Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence." We aim to provide a comprehensive strategy that advances America's national interests.

The 2019 EO laid a crucial foundation. However, the intervening years have witnessed an acceleration in AI development that necessitates a significant update. We are now in a qualitatively different phase of the technological race, one that demands even greater ambition, urgency, and a more finely-tuned strategic approach. The January 2025 EO recognizes this need, and our recommendations are designed to directly support its implementation.

Our recommendations, presented below, are largely structured around the five key pillars of the 2019 EO. We have significantly expanded upon these pillars. We also added a dedicated section on national security—reflecting the inextricably intertwined nature of AI and national power in the 21st century—and, as sought in the Request for Information, a section on Protecting Our Advantages for AI Dominance.

We welcome the opportunity to engage on our input and stand ready to address any questions you may have regarding our response.

Respectfully,

Ylli Bajraktari
President and CEO
Special Competitive Studies Project

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Contact:
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Overarching Vision: American Leadership in the Age of Artificial Intelligence

The ultimate purpose of the National AI Action Plan should be to secure and solidify American leadership in the age of artificial intelligence, culminating in the achievement of prosperous and secure artificial general intelligence (AGI). This is not merely a technological goal but a national imperative with profound implications for our security, prosperity, and way of life. Achieving this vision requires a commitment to the following transformative objectives:

- **Be the First Nation to Develop AGI:** America must always stay ahead in AI, including reaching AGI first.[2] The United States must ensure that this transformative technology is aligned with American values and interests. This requires a concerted, national effort that unites the best minds in government, our national labs, industry, and academia.

- **Protect Our Citizens:** We must leverage AI to protect our citizens from a wide range of threats, from pandemics and bioweapons to cyberattacks and intellectual property (IP) theft.[3] Initiatives like National MedShield[4] are crucial for proactively addressing these challenges and ensuring the safety, security, and well-being of all Americans.

- **Transform Education with AI:** We must fundamentally transform our educational system to prepare future generations for an AI-driven world. This requires integrating AI tools into classrooms, providing personalized AI tutors for all students, and fostering a culture of lifelong learning and adaptation.

- **Achieve Unparalleled Military Advantage:** The U.S. military must accelerate the adoption and integration of AI across all domains of warfare and mission sets.[5] This will ensure that our armed forces maintain a technologically empowered lethal edge over any potential adversary.

- **Enhance Economic Competitiveness:** The United States must leverage AI to drive unprecedented economic growth and prosperity, including by powering an industry of the future to include advanced manufacturing and robotics.

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[2] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[3] Final Report, National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence at 43 (2021).
[4] Welcome to MedShield: A National Biodefense System in the Age of AI, Special Competitive Studies Project (2024); National Action Plan for US Leadership in Biotechnology, Special Competitive Studies Project at 8 (2023).
[5] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4-5 (2025).

Key Principles Guiding America's AI Dominance

The United States must pursue a National AI Strategy that ensures American preeminence in the field of artificial intelligence. In a world of accelerating technological change and great-power competition, AI represents a critical strategic domain. Our approach must be clear-eyed and unwavering: to maintain a decisive advantage in AI, safeguard our national security, bolster our economic prosperity, and project American influence abroad. This strategy should be guided by the following core principles:

- **Competitive Dominance:** The United States must not cede leadership in AI to strategic competitors. We should aggressively invest in research and development, foster a vibrant domestic AI industry, and take all necessary measures to ensure that we remain at the forefront of this transformative technology.

- **National Security Imperative:** AI is fundamentally reshaping the national security landscape.[6] We need to prioritize the development and deployment of AI capabilities that enhance our military strength, intelligence gathering, and decision-making, ensuring our ability to deter aggression and protect American interests.

- **Economic Engine:** AI will be a powerful engine for economic growth and job creation. Our strategy should foster an environment that encourages innovation, supports American businesses, and ensures that the benefits of AI are broadly shared across our society.

- **Strategic Partnerships:** While prioritizing American leadership, our strategy should also recognize the value of strategic partnerships with allies and like-minded nations. We should collaborate on research, development, and standards-setting while remaining vigilant against technology transfer and intellectual property theft.

1. Infrastructure Requirements for AI Dominance

To dominate in AI, the United States requires a robust infrastructure foundation built upon abundant energy from next-generation nuclear and fusion; nationwide advanced networks (6G and beyond) that are high-bandwidth, secure, and resilient; a national network of secure, high-performance computing clusters, including quantum capabilities; and strategically located, gigawatt-scale data centers, ideally co-located with advanced energy sources. These interconnected elements—energy, networks, and computing (which includes data centers)—are essential for sustained U.S. AI leadership.

[6] 2024 Report to Congress, U.S.-China Economic and Security Review Commission at 169 (2024).

Furthermore, all of this work must be underpinned by robust U.S.-driven AI research & development (R&D).

Energy

- **Next-Generation Nuclear Power**[7]
    - Aggressively deploy Small Modular Reactors (SMRs) and microreactors to provide the dense, reliable, and scalable power needed for power-hungry AI workloads.
    - Streamline regulatory approvals and provide financial incentives for SMR development and deployment.

- **Fusion Energy Breakthrough**
    - Establish a "National Fusion Goal" of construction of the world's first commercial power plant within the decade.[8]

- **Grid Modernization**
    - Upgrade and expand power transmission and energy storage to ensure efficient and resilient energy delivery to AI data centers, mitigating intermittency from renewable sources and enhancing grid stability.[9]

Networks

- **National Advanced Networks Strategy**[10]
    - Develop and implement a comprehensive strategy for 6G and beyond including optical networks. This strategy should consider core elements such as R&D resources, spectrum allocation, coordination with allies, security, standard-setting, and mechanisms to promote and fund secure digital infrastructure development around the world.
    - Coordinate efforts across government agencies, especially among the Federal Communications Commission and the Departments of Commerce and Defense.

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[7] Fortifying American Energy Dominance in the Age of AI, Special Competitive Studies Project at 2 (2024).

[8] Fusion Power: Enabling 21st Century American Dominance, SCSP Commission on the Scaling of Fusion Energy at 5 (2025).

[9] Fortifying American Energy Dominance in the Age of AI, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4, 7 (2024); National Action Plan for United States Leadership in Next-Generation Energy, Special Competitive Studies Project at 30 (2024).

[10] Memos to the President: Network Technologies, Special Competitive Studies Project (2025).

- **Secure Telecommunications Supply Chain**[11]
    - Diversify sources of critical components, incentivize domestic manufacturing of radio access network equipment, and continue to promote development of infrastructure that is modular and based on open interfaces.
    - Establish robust physical and cybersecurity standards for network equipment.

Compute

- **National Secure AI Cloud**
    - Establish a secure, government-accessible computing cluster to facilitate private sector and government collaboration.[12]

- **National Quantum-AI Platform**
    - Develop a 1 million qbit fault-tolerant quantum computer integrated with advanced AI models on classical computers.[13]

- **Opening Federal Lands**
    - Identify and develop suitable sites for gigawatt-scale data centers co-located with next-generation energy sources.
    - Provide secure locations for critical AI infrastructure.

AI Research & Development

- **Invest in AI R&D**
    - As recommended by the NSCAI, maintain American technological leadership and boost national competitiveness through increased investment in federal AI R&D by gradually scaling non-defense AI R&D to $32 billion annually.[14]

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[11] National Action Plan for U.S. Leadership in Advanced Networks, Special Competitive Studies Project at 9 (2023).
[12] Memos to the President: Artificial General Intelligence (AGI), Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).
[13] National Action Plan for United States Leadership in Advanced Compute & Microelectronics, Special Competitive Studies Project at 17 (2023); Memos to the President: Quantum Computing, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2024).
[14] Fueling Innovation: Insights into Federal AI R&D Investment, Special Competitive Studies Project at 8 (2024); Final Report, National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence at 188 (2021).

2. Forging Public-Private Partnerships for AI Advancement

Realizing the full potential of AI and securing U.S. leadership requires robust collaboration between government, industry, academia, and other stakeholders. Strategic public-private partnerships are essential for scaling AI resources, widening access, and accelerating innovation.

- **Regional Innovation Zones**[15]
    - Launch pilot programs for regional AI hubs to empower localities to become first movers in their region to adopt emerging technologies.
    - Foster local AI ecosystems to accelerate technology innovation and adoption.

- **Finance Mechanism for Advanced AI Infrastructure**
    - Utilize the creation of a U.S. Sovereign Wealth Fund to invest in capital-intensive, large-scale AI infrastructure and AI-enabled technologies that are critical to national security.[16]

- **Federal Data Utility Hub**
    - Establish a shared data hub to increase Americans' access to high-value government datasets for research and everyday tasks. The data hub should:
        - Empower individuals, startups, and small businesses to drive scientific advancements without redundant data-collection efforts;
        - Create rotational programs to embed private-sector data experts in federal agencies and vice versa, fostering knowledge transfer and innovation; and
        - Partner with universities and private institutions to train the next generation of data scientists and AI researchers to fill the void for AI jobs in government.

- **Preserve the National Artificial Intelligence Research Resource (NAIRR)**
    - Ensure sustained support for the NAIRR to provide broad academic access to data, AI software, and compute power.[17]

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[15] Memos to the President: Future Tech Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[16] Memos to the President: Artificial General Intelligence (AGI), Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[17] Fueling Innovation: Insights into Federal AI R&D Investment, Special Competitive Studies Project at 16 (2024).

3. Defining Domestic and International Standards for AI

The United States must proactively shape the international AI standards landscape to ensure alignment with American interests. This requires a multi-pronged approach encompassing both domestic regulatory action and strategic international engagement.

- **AI Deregulation**
  - Implement a streamlined regulatory approach focused on high-consequence applications.[18]

- **National Data Strategy**[19]
  - Develop a comprehensive strategy to harmonize federal data practices.
  - Promote effective data governance and responsible data sharing.

- **Launch a Rapid Review Program**
  - Establish expedited approval pathways for high-impact AI solutions to unlock rapid scientific gains in areas such as drug discovery and energy.[20]

- **Integrate AI into Regulatory Processes**[21]
  - Leverage AI tools to enhance regulatory efficiency and effectiveness.
  - Improve government oversight through AI-powered analysis.

- **Strengthen IP for Competition**
  - Issue an Executive Order recognizing intellectual property as a national priority.[22]
  - Reform Patent and Trial Appeal Board by implementing a "one and done rule," aligning standards across forums, and stopping forum shopping.
  - Overturn and firmly reject Bayh-Dole proposals that undermine innovation, restrict technological progress, or weaken America's competitive edge in AI and other critical industries.
  - Halt any discussions of waiving U.S. IP rights under the Agreement on Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS), as such actions risk undermining American innovation, weakening global AI competitiveness, and setting a dangerous precedent for future technological advancements.

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[18] Framework for Identifying Highly Consequential AI Use Cases, Special Competitive Studies Project & Johns Hopkins University Applied Physics Laboratory (2023).
[19] National Data Action Plan, Special Competitive Studies Project (2022).
[20] Memos to the President: AI Governance, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).
[21] Memos to the President: AI Governance, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).
[22] Final Report, National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence at 207 (2021).

- Empower U.S. courts to issue patent infringement injunctions.
- Empower U.S. courts to issue injunctions that block access to foreign websites or online services primarily engaged in copyright infringement.

- **Bolster U.S. Engagement in International Standards Setting**
    - Leverage the expertise at the National Institute of Standards and Technology to support active U.S. industry and government participation in key standards-setting bodies to challenge discriminatory regulations that hinder U.S. AI innovation.[23]

- **Protect Children Online**
    - Establish a National Kids' Protection Officer within the Federal Trade Commission to ensure consistent safety standards for families, clear compliance guidance for businesses, and accelerated innovation in family-friendly technologies.[24] This is especially crucial in an age where AI drives children's digital platforms, content moderation, and child data protection, and can be used as a tool to modify and exploit children's images and likeness.

4. Building the AI Talent Pipeline

America's human capital is a critical asset in the global AI competition. A comprehensive strategy is needed to cultivate, attract, and retain top AI talent, ensuring a workforce ready for the challenges and opportunities of the AI era. To create a cornerstone for this effort, the White House should update its strategy for science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) education from the first Trump Administration.[25]

- **K-16 AI Education**
    - Equip all K-16 public schools with AI tools by 2030 by coordinating with state and local governments to foster an educational system that is responsive to the needs of the 21st-century economy.[26]

- **Personalized AI Tutors**
    - Scale platforms to provide personalized AI tutoring for all students to enhance learning outcomes nationwide.[27]

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[23] Memos to the President: AI Governance, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).
[24] Memos to the President: AI Governance, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[25] Charting a Course for Success: America's Strategy for STEM Education, National Science & Technology Council's Committee on STEM Education (2018).
[26] Memos to the President: Talent Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[27] Memos to the President: Talent Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).

- **Global Talent Acquisition**[28]
    - To attract and retain the world's best and brightest minds:
        - Raise the cap for H-1B visas and eliminate the cap for advanced STEM degree holders.
        - Remove green card caps for exceptional AI talent.
        - Add high-skilled AI technologists to the Department of Labor's list of Schedule A occupations to provide new recruitment pathways.

- **Enhance Federal Workforce Programs**
    - Redesign federal workforce development programs for upskilling to include training for using cutting-edge AI and associated tools.[29]

- **AI-Powered Job Matching**
    - Incentivize public-private partnerships for skills-based job matching platforms to connect workers to roles based on their skillsets, provide real-time personal AI career coaching, and help employers identify qualified candidates—supporting a broader shift toward skill-based hiring.[30]

- **National Reserve Digital Corps (NRDC)**
    - Establish a civilian reserve force of skilled technologists to address critical national security and technology needs.[31] Digital reservists can use technology to help guide projects and bring technical solutions to the government.

- **U.S. Digital Service Academy (USDSA)**
    - Establish an accredited institution for digital expertise to train and cultivate the next generation of public service tech leaders that are needed to modernize government.[32]

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[28] Restoring the Sources of Techno-Economic Advantage, Special Competitive Studies Project at 44 (2022).
[29] Memos to the President: Talent Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).
[30] Memos to the President: Talent Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).
[31] Final Report, National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence at 360 (2021); see also Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 6 (2025).
[32] Final Report, National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence at 127 (2021); see also Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).

5. Making America the International Partner of Choice on AI

U.S. global leadership in AI requires a proactive and strategic approach to international engagement. This involves defending American innovation, fostering collaboration with allies, and addressing competition from adversaries.

- **Defend American Innovation**
  - Advocate for fair market access and prevent discriminatory treatment of American tech companies.[33]
  - Build a new export control regime with key allies and partners to prevent the leakage of U.S. innovation to our adversaries (see section 7 on "Protecting Our Advantages for AI Dominance").[34]

- **Pursue AI Interoperability**
  - Enable technology transfers to trusted allies and partners to ensure they can operate on common technology platforms and standards, and work seamlessly alongside American diplomats and military forces to advance our interests.[35]
  - Develop a competitive technology package (e.g. network, compute infrastructure, digital platforms, and associated financing) that America can promote with partners in both advanced and emerging economies to prevent partners from looking to PRC technology options.

- **"FVEY" Model for Sensitive Technologies**
  - Structure alliance cooperation around the Five Eyes model for sensitive technologies with national security implications (e.g. AGI).[36] For such sensitive technologies, the United States must not only look to organize its most capable partners to innovate and develop them more quickly than its rivals, but must also be mindful about protecting such technologies from broader proliferation.

- **Presidential Envoy for Global Technology Competition**
  - Appoint a Presidential Envoy to lead and organize America's global technology engagement and to execute the steps to make America the international partner of choice on AI.[37]

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[33] Memos to the President: Foreign Policy, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).
[34] Memos to the President: Foreign Policy, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).
[35] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 6 (2025); see also Memos to the President: Pooling Competitive Advantage, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).
[36] Memos to the President: Pooling Competitive Advantage, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[37] Memos to the President: Foreign Policy, Special Competitive Studies Project at 6 (2025).

  - Modernize the Department of State for technology competition, including integrating AI-driven platforms to streamline and elevate the Department's analytic and decision-making functions so American diplomats are equipped with cutting-edge technology to advance American interests around the world.[38]

6. AI for National Security

Artificial intelligence is fundamentally transforming the national security landscape, presenting both unprecedented opportunities and novel threats. The United States must prioritize the development and deployment of AI to maintain its strategic advantage.

- **AI for National Security Decision Advantage**
  - Mandate the use of the most advanced AI models across national security agencies to accelerate AI adoption.[39]

- **AI for Defense**
  - Identify operation centers and weapons platforms where the Department of Defense (DoD) can immediately and securely integrate AI models to enable better informed and faster decision making,[40] and deliver more precise and lethal effects.
  - Stand up a Digital Warfare Corps that would unify and standardize the recruitment, training, and equipping of a digital corps, with cyber, electronic warfare, AI, and cognitive warfare as its core mission.[41]
  - Establish a dedicated innovation budget, starting at 1% of the DoD's overall budget, and increase annually thereafter. The acquisition priorities for this budget would be AI, software, and automation.[42]

- **AI for Intelligence**
  - Increase collection of secret intelligence on adversaries' national security AI capabilities to provide the means to disrupt these systems when necessary and harden the security of U.S.-based frontier AI labs.[43]
  - Conduct and brief net assessments on key technological trends to identify gaps and guide resource decisions.[44]

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[38] Memos to the President: Foreign Policy, Special Competitive Studies Project at 6 (2025).
[39] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 6 (2025).
[40] Generative AI: The Future of Innovation Power, Special Competitive Studies Project at 145 (2023).
[41] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).
[42] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[43] Memos to the President: Intelligence Community, Special Competitive Studies Project at 7 (2025).
[44] Memos to the President: Intelligence Community, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025).

- Prioritize faster innovation and streamline approval processes through closer partnerships with the private sector and diversified talent acquisition mechanisms, including private sector rotation opportunities.[45]
- Expand the use of Other Transactional Authority (OTA) to speed up AI deployment, prioritizing contracts with smaller, innovative firms.[46]

- **Startup IP and Security Playbook**
  - Develop national security playbooks to help small companies and startups bolster security from development to deployment.[47]

- **Protect National Security Critical Datasets**
  - Identify and protect critical datasets, such as supply chain resilience analysis or genetic information, from foreign exploitation.[48]

- **Counter-AI Options**
  - Develop options and undertake preparatory measures against adversarial AI.[49]
  - Protect against foreign national security AI systems.

7. Protecting Our Advantages for AI Dominance

Maintaining American leadership in AI requires not only accelerating our own innovation but also implementing strategic measures to protect our advantages from being eroded by competitors, particularly the People's Republic of China. This involves a two-pronged approach:

- **Hardware: Strategic Export Controls**[50]
  - Implement and continuously update robust export controls on advanced semiconductor manufacturing equipment, high-end graphics processing units (GPUs), and other critical hardware essential for AI development.
  - Seek input from industry on creative solutions to counter PRC circumvention of U.S. laws.
  - Collaborate with allies to establish multilateral export control regimes for AI-related hardware.

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[45] Memos to the President: Intelligence Community, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5-8 (2025).
[46] Memos to the President: Intelligence Community, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).
[47] Memos to the President: Future Tech Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 4 (2025).
[48] Data's Role in Unlocking Scientific Potential, Special Competitive Studies Project at 13 (2024).
[49] Memos to the President: Defense Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 5 (2025).
[50] National Action Plan for U.S. Leadership in Advanced Compute & Microelectronics, Special Competitive Studies Project (2023).

  - Pursue the R&D on-chip security features to reduce the risk of export control circumvention and unauthorized use.

- **Research Security: Protecting Intellectual Property and Preventing Technology Theft**
  - Commit to maintaining support for the Safeguarding the Entire Community of the U.S. Research Ecosystem (SECURE), which helps to protect American innovation from exploitation.[51]
  - Strengthen research security protocols at universities and research institutions receiving federal funding. This includes:
    - Enhanced vetting of researchers and collaborators.
    - Increased cybersecurity measures for research data and networks.
    - Clear guidelines on disclosure of foreign funding and affiliations.
  - Expand counterintelligence efforts focused on identifying and preventing technology theft in the AI sector.
  - Promote awareness and training on research security best practices within the AI research community.
  - Work with universities to track unusual patterns of activity.

8. Conclusion

The imperative for American leadership in artificial intelligence cannot be overstated. The recommendations presented in this document provide a comprehensive and decisive roadmap for achieving and maintaining that leadership in the face of a rapidly evolving technological landscape and a determined strategic competitor in the People's Republic of China. The time for bold action is now.

To ensure effective implementation of this National AI Action Plan, we reiterate our strong recommendation for the establishment of a White House Technology Competitiveness Council (TCC).[52] This council, co-convened by the AI Czar and the Director of the Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP), should be empowered to orchestrate a whole-of-government approach, driving innovation, fostering collaboration, and managing the inherent risks of advanced AI. The TCC would serve as the central coordinating body, ensuring that all elements of this strategy—from infrastructure development to workforce training to international engagement—are aligned and effectively executed.

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[51] Research Security at the National Science Foundation, U.S. National Science Foundation (last accessed 2025).

[52] Memos to the President: Future Tech Transition, Special Competitive Studies Project at 3 (2025); see also Final Report, National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence at 166 (2021).

The Special Competitive Studies Project, with its deep commitment to American technological preeminence, stands ready to provide any and all assistance in this vital endeavor. The future of our nation's security, prosperity, and global influence depends on our collective commitment to winning the race for AI dominance. We must act with urgency, vision, and the unwavering resolve to secure American leadership in the age of artificial intelligence.